

ACHILLEA

gray-green leaves. Bears compact heads of minute, buff-yellow flower heads in summer. Good for a rock garden, wall or bank. Z3–8

A. ‘Lucky Break’. Semievergreen, upright perennial. H 3ft (90cm) or more, S 20in (50cm). Has feathery, silvery-green, basal leaves. Bears flat heads of pale yellow flowers, maturing to creamy-white, in summer. Z3–9

A. ‘Martina’. Semievergreen, upright perennial. H 34in (85cm), S 20in (50cm). Has feathery, dark green foliage. Bears numerous flat heads of light greenish-yellow flowers with slightly darker centers, in summer. Z3–9

A. millefolium (Yarrow). Variable, spreading, sometimes invasive perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm). Has long, narrow, divided, dark green, basal leaves. From late spring to late summer, erect flowering stems bear flattened heads of tiny, daisy-like, white or sometimes pink flowers. Prefers poor soil. Z3–9. **‘Lansdorferglut’** (illus. p.247) bears salmon-pink flowers that fade to ivory with a pink flush.

‘Red Velvet’ (illus. p.247), H 2ft (60cm), bears rich rose-red flowers.

A. ‘Mondpagode’. Semievergreen, bushy, upright perennial. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 20in (50cm). Has feathery, grayish-green foliage. Bears domed heads of creamy-white flowers, which open light yellow-cream, in summer. Needs staking. Z3–9.

A. ‘Moon Pagoda’. See A. ‘Mondpagode’.

A. ‘Moonshine’. Upright perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm). Produces flat heads of bright yellow flowers throughout summer above a mass of small, feathery, gray-green leaves. Divide regularly in spring. Z3–8

A. ‘Paprika’ (Galaxy Series). Semievergreen, Upright perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has feathery, silvery-green, basal leaves. Bears flat heads of rich rusty-red flowers in summer. Z3–9

A. ‘Pretty Belinda’. Semievergreen, upright perennial. H and S 20in (50cm). Has aromatic, feathery, dark green, basal leaves. In summer, produces a succession of rounded, deep pink flower heads, fading to a softer color, which creates a 2-tone effect. Z3–9

A. ptarmica ‘The Pearl’ (illus. p.247). Upright perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has large heads of small, pompom-like, white flowers in summer and tapering, glossy, dark green leaves. May spread rapidly. Z3–8

A. ‘Summerwine’. Semievergreen, upright perennial. H 32in (80cm) or more, S 16in (40cm) or more. Has feathery, dark green, basal leaves. In summer bears flat heads of deep red flowers maturing to soft purplish-brown. Z4–9

A. ‘Terracotta’ (illus. p.247). Semievergreen, upright perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has feathery, gray-green, basal leaves. Produces flat heads of burnt-orange flowers, maturing to cream, in summer. Z3–9

A. ‘The Beacon’. See A. ‘Fanal’.

A. tomentosa. Mat-forming perennial. H to 14in (35cm), S 18in (45cm). Produces linear, feathery, woolly, gray-green leaves and bears flat, lemon-yellow flower heads, from early summer to early fall. Z3–9

ACHIMENES

Hot-water plant

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of erect or trailing perennials with small rhizomes and showy flowers. Prefers bright light, but not direct sunlight, and well-drained soil. Use tepid water for watering containerized plants. Allow plants to dry out after flowering and store rhizomes in a frost-free place over winter. Propagate by division of rhizomes or by seed, if available, in spring or by stem cuttings in summer.

A. antirrhina. Erect perennial. H 12in (30cm), S 6in (15cm). Has ovate, toothed leaves, to 2in (5cm) or more long and of unequal size in each opposite pair. In summer, bears funnel-shaped, red-orange flowers, to 1in (25cm) across, with yellow throats. Z15 (min. 41–50°F/5–10°C)

A. coccinea. See A. erecta.

A. erecta, syn. A. coccinea, A. pulchella. Erect, bushy, branching perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 12in (30cm). Has narrowly ovate, toothed leaves, 2½in (6cm) long, often in whorls of 3. Tubular, scarlet flowers, ½in (1cm) across, with yellow eyes are borne in summer. Z15 (min. 41–50°F/5–10°C)

A. grandiflora. Erect perennial. H and S to 2ft (60cm). Ovate, toothed leaves, 6–7in (15–18cm) long, are often reddish below. In summer, bears tubular, dark pink to purple flowers, to 2in (5cm) across, with white eyes. Z15 (min. 41–50°F/5–10°C)

A. ‘Kim Blue’. Semierect to trailing perennial. H to 12in (30cm), S 18in (45cm). Has pairs of ovate, toothed, deep green leaves, to 2½in (6cm) long, bronze-green underneath. Large, purplish blue flowers with a white center, to 2½in (6cm) across, are borne in summer. Good for a hanging basket. Z15 (min. 50–59°F/10–15°C)

A. ‘Little Beauty’ illus. p.469.

A. ‘Paul Arnold’. Erect, compact, free-flowering perennial. H and S 16in (40cm). Has ovate, toothed leaves, 2½in (6cm) long. Bears large, funnel-shaped, purple flowers, 2in (5cm) across, in summer. Z15 (min. 41–50°F/5–10°C)

A. ‘Peach Blossom’. Trailing perennial. H and S 8in (20cm). Has ovate, toothed leaves, to 2½in (6cm) long. In summer, bears large, funnel-shaped, peach-colored flowers, 2in (5cm) across. Z15 (min. 41–50°F/5–10°C)

A. pulchella. See A. erecta.

A. ‘Yellow Beauty’. Erect perennial. H 9in (24cm), S 12in (30cm). Produces pairs of ovate, toothed, slightly hairy, dark green leaves, 2in (5cm) long. Solitary, primrose-yellow flowers, 2in (5cm) across, are borne from summer to fall. Z10–12 (min. 41–50°F/5–10°C)

Achnatherum calamagrostis. See *Stipa calamagrostis*.

Acidanthera. See *Gladiolus*.

ACIPHYLLA

APIACEAE/UMBELLIFERAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, grown mainly for their architectural, spiky foliage but also for their flowers, which are produced more freely on male plants. Needs sun and well-drained soil.

Protect neck of plant from winter wet with a deep layer of stone chips. Propagate by seed when fresh, in late summer, or in early spring.

A. aurea (Golden Spaniard) illus. p.227.

A. scott-thomsonii (Giant Spaniard). Evergreen, rosette-forming perennial. H 10ft (3m) or more, S 6ft (2m). Much-dissected, spiny foliage is bronze when young, maturing to silver-gray. Prickly spikes of tiny, creamy-yellow flowers are rarely produced. Prefers a moist but well-drained site. Z8–11

A. squarrosa (Bayonet plant) illus. p.242.

ACIS

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of bulbs, grown for their pendent, bell-shaped, white or pink flowers, borne in fall or spring. Some plants prefer a moist, partially shaded site, others do best in a position in sun and in well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or early fall, or by seed in fall.

A. autumnalis, syn. *Leucojum autumnale* (Autumn snowflake), illus. p.424.

A. hiemalis, syn. A. nicaensis, *Leucojum hiemale*, L. nicaense. Early-spring-flowering bulb. H 4in (10cm), S 2in (5cm). Leafless stems produce 1 or 2 bell-shaped, waxy, white flowers, ½in (1cm) long, and has 2–4 narrowly linear, grayish green basal leaves, to 12in (30cm) long. Will survive outside in a sunny, sheltered site, but is best grown in an alpine house. Z4–8

A. nicaensis. See A. hiemalis.

A. rosea, syn. *Leucojum roseum*. Early-fall-flowering bulb. H to 4in (10cm), S 1–2in (2.5–5cm). Slender stems bear usually solitary, pale pink flowers, ½in (1cm) long. Threadlike, erect, basal leaves emerge with, or just after, flowers. Prefers sun and well-drained soil. Z3–9

ACOKANTHERA

APOCYNACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers and overall appearance. Needs full light and good drainage. Water containerized plants moderately, less when not in full growth. Propagate by seed in spring or fall or by semiripe cuttings in summer. ☉The sap and small, plumlike fruits that follow the flowers are highly toxic if ingested.

A. oblongifolia, syn. A. spectabilis, *Carissa spectabilis* (Wintersweet), illus. p.453.

A. spectabilis. See A. oblongifolia.

ACONITUM

Aconite, Monkshood, Wolf’s bane

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of perennials and biennials with poisonous, tuberous or fibrous roots and upright, sometimes scandent, stems, which bear curious, hooded flowers in summer. Leaves are mostly rounded in outline. Suitable for rock gardens or borders. Prefers a site in sun, but tolerates some shade—this may enhance flower color. Requires fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by division in fall, every 2–3 years, or by seed in fall.

☉Contact with the foliage may irritate skin; all parts are highly toxic if ingested.

A. anthora. Compact, tuberous perennial. H 24–28in (60–70cm), S 12in (30cm). Erect, leafy stems bear several hooded, yellow flowers in summer. Leaves are divided and dark green. Z5–8

A. x bicolor. See A. x cammarum ‘Bicolor’.

A. ‘Bressingham Spire’. Compact, upright, tuberous perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). Erect spikes of hooded, violet-blue flowers are borne in summer. Deeply divided leaves are glossy, dark green. Z3–7

A. x cammarum ‘Bicolor’, syn. A. x bicolor, illus. p.239.

A. carmichaelii ‘Arendsii’, syn. A.c. ‘Arends’. Erect, tuberous perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1ft (30cm). Has divided, rich green leaves and, in fall, spikes of hooded, rich deep blue flowers. Upright stems may need staking, particularly if planted in a shady site. Z3–8

A. hemsleyanum, syn. A. volubile of gardens, illus. p.204.

A. ‘Ivorine’. Upright, tuberous perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 18in (45cm). Bears hooded, creamy-white flowers in erect spikes in early summer. Strong stems bear deeply divided, glossy, green leaves. Z3–8

A. lycotonum subsp. vulparia, syn. A. orientale of gardens, A. vulparia (Wolf’s bane), illus. p.243.

A. napellus (Helmet flower, Monkshood). Upright, tuberous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 1ft (30cm). Bears tall, slender spires of hooded, light indigo-blue flowers in late summer and deeply cut, mid-green leaves. Z3–8. **‘Albiflorus’** see A.n. subsp. *vulgare* ‘Albidum’. **subsp. vulgare ‘Albidum’** (syn. A.n. ‘Albiflorus’) has white flowers.

A. ‘Newry Blue’. Upright, tuberous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 12in (30cm). Produces hooded, dark blue flowers on erect stems in summer and has deeply divided, glossy, dark green leaves. Z5–8

A. orientale of gardens. See A. lycotonum subsp. *vulparia*.

A. ‘Spark’s Variety’. Upright, tuberous perennial. H 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m), S 18in (45cm). Bears violet-blue flowers on branching stems in summer. Leaves are deeply divided, glossy and dark green. Z5–8

A. ‘Stainless Steel’ illus. p.241.

A. volubile of gardens. See A. hemsleyanum.

A. vulparia. See A. lycotonum subsp. *vulparia*.

Aconogonon. See *Persicaria*.

ACORUS

ARACEAE

Genus of semievergreen or deciduous marginal aquatic perennials, grown for their frequently aromatic foliage. Requires an open, sunny position. A. calamus needs up to 10in (25cm) depth of water. Tidy up fading foliage in fall; lift and divide plants every 3 or 4 years, in spring, as clumps become congested.

A. calamus ‘Argenteostriatus’ illus. p.434.

A. gramineus (Japanese rush). Semievergreen, aquatic perennial. H 3–14in (8–35cm), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Produces fans